her close associates noticed it, ascertained from the Delhi Police that this was done on the orders of Kao and brought this to her attention. She expressed her misgivings over the wisdom of the decision. Following this, the withdrawn Sikh police officers were posted back to her residence. However, Kao instructed that no Sikh police officer should normally be posted alone in her close proximity and that, whenever a Sikh police officer was posted in her close proximity, he should be accompanied by a non-Sikh officer.' [11] It was the violation of these instructions of Kao's that created the conditions for her assassination.

It took Sweden thirty-four years, 10,000 interviews and 134 confessions to bring a closure to the case of the murder of their popular prime minister Olof Palme in February 1989. On 10 June 2020 it was finally determined that the real killer was the self-professed eye witness, Stig Engstrom. Though the killer could not be punished for his crime as he had died in 2000, the closure was needed to start the healing process of a nation troubled by its inability to find and punish the real culprit. [12] In that context though the real killers of Indira Gandhi got the punishment that they deserved, it is still not known as to who advised Indira Gandhi on the most crucial issue of recalling those armed Sikh guards who were removed from duty at PM's residence after Operation Blue Star on Kao's advice. Also why was Satwant Singh allowed to join Beant Singh against Kao's specific instructions of not letting the two-armed Sikh guards come together and that too within the inner circle?

One of the three notes written by Kao, which is at the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library (NMML) in New Delhi (and is closed for public view till 2027, i.e., till twenty-five years after his death), is on the assassination of Indira Gandhi. It would be interesting to see whether this note contains only details of what he did to protect her life or whether it has some other information too. To bring a closure to the whole issue and in the national interest, it would be advisable to open Kao's note.

In view of all these developments, I do wish that Kao had not come out of retirement. In that context I agree with B. Raman, who says, 'The almost three-year (1981 to 1984) post-retirement tenure